PRACATICAL

1. A user reports their laptop won't power on even when plugged in. List 5 troubleshooting steps you would take to diagnose the cause, and for each step, explain what you are checking for.

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Step	What I Check
1. Check the charger	Check the adapter, cable, and charging light for damage or no power.
2. Check the power socket	Connect another device to confirm the wall socket is working.
3. Check the charging port	Look for a loose, dirty, or damaged laptop charging port.
4. Perform a power reset	Disconnect the charger, remove the battery if possible, hold the power button for 15–20 seconds, then reconnect the charger and try again.
5. Test the battery/charger	Try a known-good compatible charger or battery to find whether the battery or adapter is faulty.

**2. You receive a helpdesk ticket: 'My monitor is showing a blank screen, but the CPU seems to be running.' Write a step-by-step troubleshooting flow you would follow to identify and resolve the issue.

<em>Hint: Consider checking both hardware connections and basic display settings**

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1. **Check monitor power** – Make sure the monitor is switched ON and the power light is working.
2. **Check display cable** – Check the HDMI, DisplayPort, or VGA cable and make sure both ends are connected properly.
3. **Check monitor input** – Select the correct input source, such as HDMI or DisplayPort, from the monitor menu.
4. **Check the GPU connection** – Make sure the graphics card is properly seated and its power cables are connected.
5. **Try another cable or monitor** – Use a known-good cable or another monitor to identify whether the original cable or monitor is faulty.
6. **Check display settings** – If Windows is running, press **Windows + P** and select the correct display option.
7. **Restart the PC** – Restart the computer and check whether the display returns.
8. **Check RAM/GPU if still blank** – If there is still no display, reseat the RAM and GPU and check for POST beep codes or motherboard error indicators.

3. A user complains that their wireless mouse is unresponsive, but the keyboard works fine. Describe how you would isolate whether the issue is with the mouse, the USB port, or the system settings.

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1. **Check the mouse power** – Make sure the mouse is switched ON and replace or recharge the batteries.
2. **Check the USB receiver** – Remove the wireless receiver and plug it into another USB port.

3. **Test the USB port** – Connect a USB device, such as a pen drive, to the same port. If it works, the USB port is probably fine.
4. **Test the mouse on another PC** – Connect the mouse receiver to another computer. If the mouse still does not work, the mouse or receiver may be faulty.
5. **Check system settings** – Open Device Manager and check for errors under **Mice and other pointing devices** and **Universal Serial Bus controllers**.
6. **Check or reinstall the driver** – Update or reinstall the mouse/USB driver if Windows shows a driver problem.
7. **Confirm the problem** – Try another working wireless mouse on the original PC. If the second mouse works, the original mouse is likely faulty.

**4. Imagine you are working on a helpdesk team for a gaming cafe. One system is overheating and shutting down during use. List 3 possible hardware causes and describe how you would check each one.

<em>Hint: Think about fans, dust, and thermal paste**

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Possible Hardware Cause	**How I Would Check It**
1. Dust in fans and heatsink	Turn off and unplug the PC, open the case, and check the CPU/GPU fans and heatsinks for heavy dust. Clean them carefully with compressed air.
2. Faulty or slow fan	Start the PC and check whether the CPU and GPU fans are spinning properly. A fan that is not spinning, noisy, or running slowly may need replacement.
3. Old or dry thermal paste	Check the CPU cooler installation. If the thermal paste is old or dry, clean the old paste and apply new thermal paste correctly.